building in a multilateral setting will undoubtedly be useful for both India and Japan in the future.

Thus, one major pillar of the India–Japan relationship involves the building up of India's long-term capabilities and policy coordination with Japan. At a foundational level, India has invited Japan to invest considerably in its future great-power potential, be it through the economic backbone of infrastructure, the transfer and development of high-tech weapons systems and platforms such as the ShinMaywa US-2, or the transfer of civilian nuclear technology with few strings attached. Policy coordination involves multiple points of contact across the two governments and at high levels, ranging from the two-plus-two dialogue of foreign and defence ministers to a host of high-level working groups and dialogues in areas such as agriculture, science and technology, energy cooperation, and economic partnership. Absent a whole-of-government approach that characterises a deeply institutionalised and committed relationship such as the US–Japan alliance, these multiple institutional linkages between India and Japan are laying the foundation for deeper connections in the future in the event that both countries decide to upgrade their strategic partnership to something resembling an alliance (although an outright alliance between them is highly unlikely). Rather than balancing China or cementing some sort of values-based partnership, India and Japan have steadily gone about the business of developing the capabilities, institutional connections, and interoperability that will enable them to coordinate effectively in the future on a range of issues of interest to both governments. This is, however, a long and arduous process, particularly given the exigencies of democratic politics on both sides, as well as the long road that India must traverse before it can reliably marshal the resources necessary to be counted as a global power.